

The panda package

Estimating the blackness of fonts



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<https://github.com/samcarter/panda>

<https://ctan.org/pkg/panda>

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1 Introduction

Imagine the following problem: there is a hungry panda sitting next to you and just today, you happen to not have any bamboo with you. Now you are a $\text{\LaTeX}$ user and the only limits are your own imagination, so of course you try to draw a couple of bamboo sticks with $\text{\LaTeX}$. Here dear panda, have three bamboo sticks: $\text{\texttt{III}}$. The panda likes them and wants to make more. **However the panda uses a different font and the bamboo sticks suddenly look a lot less tasty, they look just too thin: $\text{\texttt{III}}$.**

The panda package provides estimates for the stroke width of fonts and how black the fonts look on the page. Creators of symbols etc. can use these estimates to adjust their drawings to better blend in with the surrounding text.

Yummy bamboo sticks: $\text{\texttt{III}}$

The results won't be a perfect match for all fonts and strokes can also look differently compared to the surrounding text depending on the PDF viewer and zoom level, but the results should be good enough to ensure that the symbols don't stand out immediately.

Note that this package was developed and tested with texts in Latin scripts – results might be less satisfactory if used with other scripts.

This package is work in progress, therefore I would be happy to hear your feedback and ideas how to improve the package. The development version of the source code can be found at <https://github.com/samcarter/panda>, including an issue tracker. A more stable version of the package can be found on CTAN (<https://ctan.org/pkg/panda>) and is included in both $\text{\TeX}$ Live and $\text{\MiKTeX}$ as `panda`. If you seek any other assistance (not bug reports/feature requests), I suggest asking at <https://topanswers.xyz/tex>.

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